of the electorate's disillusionment with the Congress Party and particularly its ability to deliver.[148] On the other hand, the Communist Party of India (Marxist), the more ideological offshoot of the Communist Party that had split after the Sino-Indian war, had come to power in coalitions in Kerala and West Bengal. The outbreak of a Maoist insurgency in Andhra Pradesh and the Naxalite movement in West Bengal that spring only increased the sense of susceptibility to potential Chinese subversion.[149]

Chinese actions and words vis-à-vis India worsened. There were attacks on and expulsions of Indian diplomats, and the embassy was besieged. There were also numerous articles in the *People's Daily* in praise of the Naxalites and Naga and Mizo insurgents, and calling for revolution in India. Delhi furiously objected to Radio Peking's declaration in June of support for what it called Mao-inspired Naxalites.[150] That summer, there were also Chinese military probes into Bhutanese territory and a demand that India move its embassy in Beijing. The Chinese test of a hydrogen bomb in June 1967, as the foreign minister noted, added a "new dimension to our defence problem."[151] He asserted privately that, in the context of the Cultural Revolution, "if anything, the Chinese were becoming more bellicose in their relations with India."[152] In parliament, the foreign minister asserted that there was "no doubt" that Sino-Pakistan collusion continued.[153]

Policymakers believed that the "stagnant" economic climate and the "critical" food situation made India more vulnerable to Chinese subversion—this, in turn, made it crucial to maintain the relationship with the US.[154] The Indian government tried to find out if—and to what extent—the US was willing and able to support India.[155] Officials worried that fading American agricultural surpluses and Johnson's insistence on matching commitments from other countries suggested the beginning of the end of food aid from the US.[156] Rusk had already indicated to Chagla that the American "tradition" of giving food assistance was "coming to an end;" the US would now expect payment. Gandhi told Indian chief ministers that "the whole concept of food aid has changed." However, India did not have the foreign exchange to purchase enough grain from abroad; as it was, India had to divert resources from crucial sectors like defense toward purchasing food. Thus India needed to focus even more on developing and mobilizing internal resources "so as to be less dependent on foreign aid."[157] That would